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Hi, I'm Tara. I am an Engineer specialized in AI.

Academic Background

I was awarded two bachelor's degrees simultaneously - B.S. in Electrical and Computer Engineering and B.S. in Atmospheric Sciences both at the University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign. When I was 5 and they asked me "what do you want to be when you grow up ?" I responded a "Scientist". I nearly completed the childhood-dream arc when I was offered a funded PhD at JHU in 2018 to work on the James Webb Space Telescope. You'll find out in the next section for why I say *nearly*.

What I Do

Unfortunately, at this time I was also tempted by a lucrative job offer and wandered off course and into the Sierra Nevada wilderness instead. I now serve out my sentence in the corporate world at MathWorks (Cambridge, England, UK), working on GenAI products, in a state of mild penance, frequent regret, and occasional respite when I speak with my now-unemployed physicist friends. In more recent times, outside of my profession, I've begun working on a side project in legal AI with the faculty of Law at the University of Cambridge. While some are wary of AI generated legal claims being issued by lay-persons, I feel that the recent technological advancement could also be used as a good excuse to clean up the system (where possible, to the extent feasible).

Programming Experience

I truly started writing code around 2015 when an undergrad class analyzing weather data got me interested and working at radio astronomy telescopes and facilities necessitated processing lidar and radar data in Python. I wrote considerably more of it before ~2026 (before management began "strongly encouraging" me to let Claude Code "have a go" so as to churn out a year's worth of projects in a month).

I code primarily in Python. Owing to my non-CS background at times, I am wary of



Projects

Module 1 - Portfolio web applicatio with Flask

Project Description

This project uses a micro web framework, Flask to develop a web application. The web application is a basic professional portfolio.

Project Link

[View this project on GitHub](#)

Key Takeaways

The key learnings for me were around:

1. Seeing how the factory method design is used in a Flask application. The app/___init___.py contains the "factory" with the factory method (create_app). And, run.py provides the (client) code that uses the factory.
2. How to structure a Flask application with routes, templates, and static assets (as demonstrated by this project) and use a blueprint to group routes.
3. Using Jinja template inheritance to share a consistent page layout (though there is some confusion around this concept for me that I hope to sort this out in office hours or via email).
4. Styling reusable page components with CSS.

Contact

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